

CRAFT - Timeline Assist Help

Version 1.03 | Part of the CRAFT Toolset

CRAFT - Timeline Assist is a compact dark timeline workflow tool for Autodesk 3ds Max 2027. It helps animators focus frame ranges, organize animation sections as preset bars, and jump between timing blocks without hunting through long timelines.

Main Timeline

- Drag the center of the timeline bar to pan the focused frame range.
- Drag the left or right handle to adjust focused start and end frames.
- Use the mouse wheel over the main timeline bar to zoom the focused range.
- Double-click the main timeline bar to reset to the full scene range.
- Type directly into the frame boxes to edit full range or focused range values.

Presets

- Create presets from the current focused range or from selected keyframes.
- Double-click an empty preset row to create on that row first; if the range does not fit, the tool places it in the next available row.
- Click a preset bar to focus the timeline to that exact range.
- Shift-click preset bars to multi-select them for grouped move or range edits.
- Drag preset number boxes to move a preset without triggering timeline focus.
- Drag preset edges to change the stored start and end frames.
- Double-click the preset name to rename inline.
- Right-click preset bars to rename, edit range, change color, or delete.

Preset Panel

- Row numbers count top to bottom, starting with row 1.
- Preset bars clamp before the row-number lane so labels stay readable.
- Mouse wheel scrolls vertically through preset rows.
- Alt + mouse wheel zooms the preset timeline horizontally.
- Middle mouse drag pans horizontally and scrolls vertically by row increments.
- The vertical scrollbar snaps to rows for clean alignment.

Selected Keys

- Focus on selected key range adjusts the timeline view to the min and max selected keyframes.
- Add preset from Keys creates a preset from the selected key range.

Scene Storage

- Presets are stored inside the Max file, so each scene keeps its own animation layout.
- Opening a file reloads that file's presets.
- New/reset scenes clear scene preset state.

- UI preferences such as startup, random colors, and panel visibility stay global.

Options

- Start with 3ds Max: opens the tool on startup.
- Randomize colors: applies random preset colors to newly created presets when enabled.

Release Notes

v1.03

- Added numbered preset rows.
- Reserved the row-number lane so preset bars do not overlap row labels.
- Added row-snapped scrollbar and wheel scrolling in the preset panel.
- Changed preset panel zoom to Alt + mouse wheel.
- Improved Alt-wheel handling for 3ds Max embedded Qt.
- Double-clicking an empty preset row now tries to create the preset on that row first, then falls back to another available row if needed.

v1.02

- Added multi-select for preset bars.
- Added installer cleanup improvements and updated help/support information.

Support

GitHub: <https://github.com/TheTreeHouseof95/CRAFT---Timeline-Assist.git>

Bugs/requests: <https://github.com/TheTreeHouseof95/CRAFT---Timeline-Assist/discussions>

Email: thetreehouseof95@gmail.com